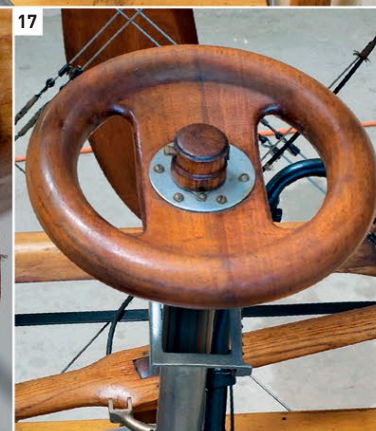
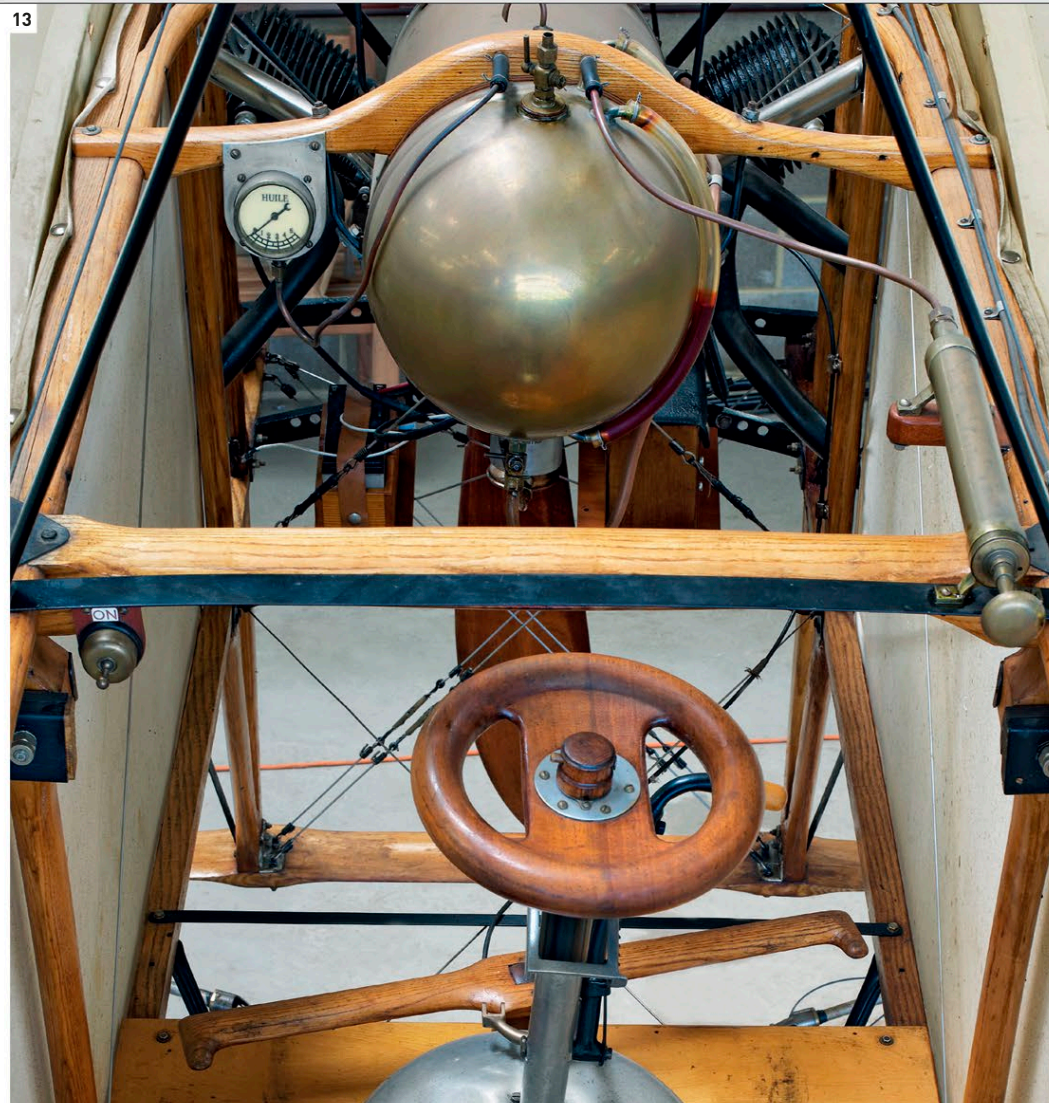
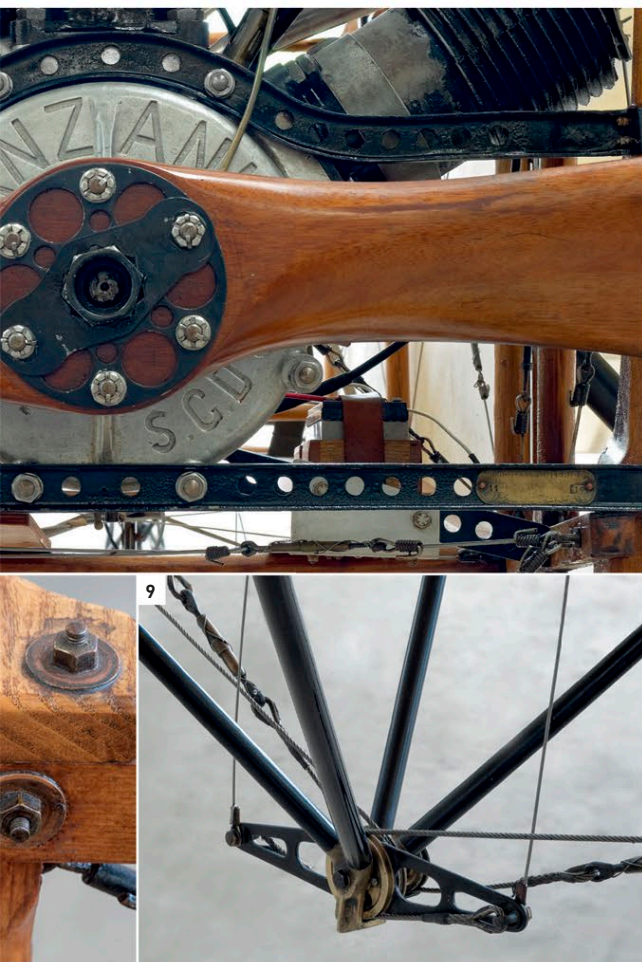




THE COCKPIT

Exposed to the elements and heat and fumes from the engine mounted just in front of his feet, the Blériot's pilot did not enjoy much comfort. The fuel tank was almost in the pilot's lap and there was no protection from fire. The only instrument was an oil pressure gauge. Airspeed and "slip" were judged by the feel of wind on the cheek. The control system looks fairly modern with a foot-operated rudder bar and hand-operated stick—moving fore and aft to control pitch, and sideways to control roll.

13. Main cockpit showing rudder bar (bottom) sitting under brass fuel tank 14. Oil pressure gauge 15. Fuel pressure pump 16. Magneto (ignition) switch 17. Nonrotating, wheel-shaped stick grip 18. Wicker seat with vented wood "cushion"